

Philipp Hilbert. *Platform-first B2B product leader for merchant lifecycle.*

Positioning, 13 years of end-to-end B2B product ownership in regulated industries, with a track record of turning fragmented merchant journeys into connected, self-serve platforms.

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§ WHY TABBY

Tabby's shift from a BNPL checkout product to a full merchant platform is exactly the inflection point where platform-thinking beats feature-shipping. The job description calls for building shared foundations, dashboards, permissions, lifecycle communications, that every B2B vertical can adopt, which is the hardest and most valuable thing a PM can do in a multi-product fintech. The cross-sell engine challenge, connecting the right merchant segment to the right product at the right moment in their lifecycle, is a systems problem as much as a product one. *That is exactly the kind of problem where a systems-first, ego-last approach compounds fastest.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not worked directly in acquiring, BNPL or the GCC market before. My fintech experience is in P2P payments and insurance SaaS rather than merchant-facing payment rails. The transferable mechanic is strong: I have spent six years building B2B platforms where onboarding friction, permission models and cross-sell sequencing were the core product problems, just in adjacent regulated industries.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, day-to-day coding assistance
- **Cursor**, editor-native AI for rapid iteration
- **Lovable**, fast front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy UI exploration
- **GPT**, research, edge-case generation and copy review
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder decks and roadmap communication

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, REST APIs, Dagster, dbt, SQL, Figma, Jira, Confluence, Miro, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

§ SIDE PROJECT

LIBERATION OF BAJOR GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP →

A multi-agent coding framework built to run autonomous development loops.

- Coordinates multiple LLM agents across a shared file queue to decompose and execute software tasks without a human in the loop.
- Built on a file-queue-based agent architecture: each agent reads task files, writes outputs, and signals completion, making the loop restartable and auditable.
- Running in production for personal crypto backtesting and trading-bot projects.
- Demonstrates the platform instinct this role demands: shared primitives, clear agent boundaries, migration paths, the same thinking Tabby's B2B foundations need.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT TABBY

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow onboarding, account management and support calls; map the current merchant lifecycle state by state across BNPL, ads and the business account to locate where merchants drop, stall or never cross-sell.

WEEK 2

Instrument, slice, prioritise.

Pull funnel data on time-to-first-value and cross-sell attach rate by merchant segment; identify the two or three highest-leverage gaps where a shared capability would unblock multiple vertical teams at once.

WEEK 3+

Ship, align, close loops.

Deliver a first version of one shared foundation, most likely a self-serve onboarding flow or a notification primitive, prove the internal adoption model with one vertical team, and publish the roadmap that sets boundaries for the others.

I COVER LETTER

Tabby is solving the problem I find most interesting in fintech: turning a strong product suite into a platform that feels like a single, coherent system to the merchant using it. The job description is precise about where the hard work lives, shared permissions, lifecycle communications, a cross-sell engine, and internal adoption of platform capabilities. Those are not feature requests; they are the connective tissue that determines whether a multi-product fintech scales or fragments.

My most directly comparable engagement was at EMIL Group, a B2B SaaS platform serving insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters. When I arrived, an 18-person delivery organisation was losing its senior engineers, client trust was eroding, and no shared foundations existed across the product lines. I restructured the organisation into three lean teams with clear ownership boundaries, then shipped the Claims Center, a net-new product, from concept to production, cutting time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week. The mechanism was not heroics; it was defining the shared states, permissions and lifecycle stages once, so each team could build on them instead of rebuilding them.

At Rohde & Schwarz I did the same for an internal AI data platform: introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD across a multinational team, cut rollout time from days to 30 minutes, and made the platform hotfix-capable. More importantly, I killed the beautiful UI that nobody clicked and

redirected the product to the developer-code-first surface that people actually used. That discipline, instrument before you commit, let usage data set direction, is how I approach merchant lifecycle work too. Time-to-first-value and products-per-merchant are not reporting metrics; they are the signal that tells you whether your onboarding and cross-sell logic is actually working.

My fintech background is adjacent rather than identical: Kvitt Payment Solutions, a mobile P2P payments startup I built from zero and took to acquisition inside the Sparkasse girocard ecosystem, gave me direct experience in payment UX, funnel friction and the compliance constraints that shape what a self-serve flow can and cannot do. I have also built a two-sided B2B marketplace, construct8, from scratch, alone, with LLM agents across the funnel and an anonymity-until-payment model that protects both parties until commitment. I say this not to pad the list but because running a zero-to-one product solo, with agentic automation doing the operational work, is the clearest proof I have that I hold the whole value chain in view rather than just the backlog.

Tabby's mission, financial systems that work for people rather than institutions, is one I find credible because the product evidence supports it. I would bring the systems mindset, the B2B platform experience and the data-first discipline this role needs.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager and product owner with 13 years of end-to-end ownership in regulated B2B environments: insurance SaaS, payments, public-sector analytics, defence AI, and healthcare. Strongest in operationally complex domains, onboarding, permissions, self-serve flows, where shared platform foundations determine whether a multi-product organisation scales or fragments. Comfortable owning a prioritised roadmap across vertical teams without direct authority, and fluent enough in engineering and data to close the loop from metric to shipped fix.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Platform and B2B Product: lifecycle ownership, onboarding and KYB flows, self-serve admin tooling, permissions modelling, cross-sell sequencing, net revenue retention, products-per-merchant metrics.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, go-to-market support.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning.

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional alignment, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, OpenShift, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, Django, SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership and financial planning.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI 2024 TO 2025

Introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD across a multinational team; cut rollout from days to 30 minutes and made the platform hotfix-capable. Redirected the product from a zero-engagement UI to a developer-code-first surface based on instrumented usage data.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023 TO 2024

Integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline; introduced Dagster and dbt for autonomous quarterly imports; migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers; carried a full UI relaunch through the same period. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE 2023

Cut a bloated roadmap to the top 10% of features; user acceptance rose more than fivefold. Implemented the CGM interface into KIS workflows; reduced digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · B2B INSURANCE SAAS 2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure. Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL AND PAYMENTS 2021 TO 2022

Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · INTERIM PRODUCT OWNER · GOVERNMENT 2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PROXY PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE 2019 TO 2020

Migrated a legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE 2017 TO 2018

WLAN rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING B2B MARKETPLACE 2025 TO 2026

Zero to one alone: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · IT SECURITY 2016 TO 2021

Shipped a three-layer quantum-secure encryption product that installs in under two minutes; later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · NANOTECHNOLOGY 2018 TO 2021

Took a fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH 2013 TO 2018

Mobile group P2P payments built from zero and taken to acquisition; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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